



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Cook Training

Galley hygiene, food safety, stock control, menu planning and galley safety practices every ship's cook is expected to master.

MLC 2006

HACCP

Company SMS

What We Will Cover

01

The Cook's Role & MLC 2006

Duties, certification and the catering standard the Convention sets

02

Galley Hygiene & Food Safety

HACCP principles applied to a working ship's galley

03

Food Storage & Stock Rotation

Temperature control, labelling and FIFO

04

Menu Planning & Basic Nutrition

Feeding a working crew a balanced, varied diet

05

Galley Safety

Fire, knives, hot surfaces and safe footing at sea

06

Waste Management in the Galley

Segregating and disposing of galley waste correctly



SECTION 1

The Cook's Role & MLC 2006

Feeding the crew well is not a courtesy — it is a certified, regulated function of the ship's Safety Management System.

01

What MLC 2006 Requires

The Maritime Labour Convention, 2006 sets binding minimum standards for catering aboard every covered ship.

- Regulation 3.2 requires ships to carry a qualified cook, trained and certified to prepare food that is nutritious, varied and prepared in hygienic conditions.
- A ship's cook must hold a certificate of competency recognised by the flag state before being engaged in that capacity.
- Food and drinking water must be of appropriate quality, nutritional value and quantity, adequately varied, and take account of crew numbers, religious and cultural needs.
- The galley, food storage and dining areas must meet MLC's standards for space, ventilation, lighting and hygiene, and are subject to flag state and PSC inspection.
- The Company SMS translates these requirements into ship-specific procedures for menu planning, hygiene, stock control and inspection routines.



A Certified Trade

Being 'the cook' aboard ship is a recognised profession under MLC — it carries a formal qualification requirement, not just kitchen experience ashore.

CORE RESPONSIBILITIES

The Cook's Day-to-Day Duties

The role covers far more than meal preparation alone.

1

Plan — build varied, balanced menus within budget and stock on hand

2

Prepare — cook and serve meals safely and hygienically, on schedule

3

Control — manage stock, storage, rotation and galley cleanliness

What the Role Involves

A ship's cook works largely independently, often as the galley's only qualified crew member.



Meal Preparation

Planning and cooking meals that suit the crew's nationality mix, workload and any dietary or medical needs.



Stock & Budget Control

Ordering provisions within the victualling budget and keeping accurate consumption and stock records.



Hygiene & Sanitation

Maintaining the galley, stores and equipment to the hygiene standard required by MLC and the Company SMS.



Training & Handover

Briefing galley assistants or messmen, and handing over menus, stock levels and routines to a relieving cook.



SECTION 2

Galley Hygiene & Food Safety

02

A ship at sea cannot call an ambulance for food poisoning — hygiene discipline in the galley is a safety-critical routine, not a preference.

Applying HACCP in the Galley

Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points is a system for preventing food safety problems, not just reacting to them.

- Identify the food safety hazards in each step of storage, preparation and service: biological, chemical and physical.
- Determine the Critical Control Points (CCPs) — the specific steps, such as cooking or chilling, where a control can prevent or eliminate the hazard.
- Set critical limits at each CCP, most commonly core cooking, chilling and hot-holding temperatures, and monitor them consistently.
- Take corrective action immediately when a limit is not met — reheat, discard or re-cook rather than serve food that failed a check.
- Keep simple, honest records of checks performed; a documented temperature log is what turns a routine into demonstrable food safety.



Prevention, Not Cure

HACCP's entire value is catching a hazard before food reaches the crew — a single case of galley-borne illness at sea can affect the whole ship's complement at once.

Four Pillars of Galley Hygiene

These four areas cover the great majority of food safety risk in a working galley.



Personal Hygiene

Handwashing before handling food, clean whites, tied-back hair, and no working while unwell with a gastrointestinal illness.



Cross-Contamination Control

Separate boards, knives and storage for raw meat, fish and ready-to-eat food, with strict handwashing between tasks.



Temperature Control

Keeping food out of the danger zone by chilling promptly, cooking thoroughly, and hot-holding above the safe minimum.



Cleaning & Sanitation

A structured cleaning schedule for surfaces, equipment and stores, using approved chemicals correctly diluted.

Hygiene in Practice

Small, consistent habits prevent the great majority of galley food safety incidents.



Do

- Wash hands after handling raw food, waste, or touching your face or hair
- Use colour-coded boards and utensils for raw and ready-to-eat food
- Check and log core temperatures for high-risk dishes before serving
- Report any illness with vomiting or diarrhoea to the Master before working



Don't

- Don't taste food with a utensil you then return to the pot
- Don't store raw meat or fish above ready-to-eat food in the chiller
- Don't leave perishable food out at ambient temperature longer than necessary
- Don't use a cleaning cloth on food surfaces and equipment surfaces alike



SECTION 3

Food Storage & Stock Rotation

03

A voyage can last weeks without a resupply — how provisions are stored and rotated determines what actually reaches the plate in good condition.

STORAGE DISCIPLINE

Storing Provisions Correctly

Correct storage protects both food safety and the victualling budget by reducing spoilage and waste.

- Store food in the correct zone for its type — dry store, chiller or freezer — at the temperature that zone requires, checked and logged daily.
- Label every item with its date of receipt and, where applicable, its opening or use-by date once a sealed container is broken.
- Keep raw and ready-to-eat food physically separated in storage, with raw items stored below ready-to-eat items to prevent drip contamination.
- Rotate stock using First In, First Out (FIFO): new deliveries go to the back, older stock moves to the front for use first.
- Inspect stores regularly for pests, damaged packaging, or signs of spoilage, and remove affected items immediately.



Check the Numbers, Not the Feel

A chiller or freezer can feel cold while running above its safe setpoint — always verify with a calibrated thermometer, not by touch.

REFERENCE

Storage Zones and Temperatures

Each storage zone has a defined safe range that should be checked and logged at least once per watch or shift.

Zone	Typical Temperature	Typical Items
Dry Store	Cool, dry, below 25°C, away from direct heat	Grains, tinned goods, oils, dry provisions
Chiller	0°C to 5°C	Fresh meat, fish, dairy, prepared ready-to-eat food
Freezer	-18°C or below	Frozen meat, fish, vegetables and bulk provisions
Hot-Holding	Above 63°C	Cooked food awaiting service

Managing Stock Day to Day

Good stock discipline is what stretches provisions safely across a long voyage.



Do

- Date-label items as soon as they are received or opened
- Move older stock to the front of shelves and chillers every delivery
- Record stock levels regularly to plan ahead for the next port call
- Keep a written record of any stock discarded, with the reason



Don't

- Don't place new stock in front of older stock out of convenience
- Don't rely on memory for use-by dates on opened containers
- Don't overload chillers or freezers beyond their rated capacity
- Don't serve food past its use-by date, even under time pressure



SECTION 4

Menu Planning & Basic Nutrition

04

A well-planned menu keeps a physically demanding job sustainable — and keeps morale up on a long voyage.

Building a Working Menu

A good menu balances nutrition, variety, budget and what stock is actually available on any given day.

- Plan menus in advance, on a rotating cycle, to ensure variety across the week and avoid repeating the same dish too often.
- Account for the crew's nationality mix, religious requirements and any individual dietary or medical restrictions known to the cook.
- Balance each meal across food groups: carbohydrates for energy, protein for repair, and fruit or vegetables wherever stock allows.
- Adjust portion sizes and calorie content for the physical demands of shipboard work, which are often higher than shore-based jobs.
- Keep the victualling budget in view when planning, substituting where needed without compromising nutritional balance.



Don't Forget Hydration

Engine room and deck work in hot climates significantly increases fluid needs — fresh drinking water and options beyond tea and coffee should always be available.

Balancing the Plate

A working knowledge of these basics helps the cook plan meals that actually sustain a demanding job.



Balanced Menu Planning

Rotating menus that vary protein, starch and vegetables across the week, not just from meal to meal.



Protein & Recovery

Meat, fish, eggs and pulses support muscle repair after physically demanding watches and maintenance work.



Fruit, Vegetables & Vitamins

Fresh or preserved produce, used while available, to cover vitamin and fibre needs across a long voyage.



Hydration

Constant access to safe drinking water, especially important in hot engine spaces and tropical routes.

Structuring the Day's Meals

A predictable meal schedule supports watchkeeping routines and crew wellbeing alike.

3+

Main meals served daily, timed around watch and work schedules

24/7

Basic refreshments (tea, coffee, snacks) available for watchkeepers off the main meal times

1

Menu cycle reviewed and varied regularly to avoid repetition over a long voyage



SECTION 5

Galley Safety

Heat, sharp tools and a moving deck make the galley one of the ship's higher-risk workspaces — safe habits are non-negotiable.

05

CORE HAZARDS

Working Safely in the Galley

The galley combines several hazards found nowhere else on the ship in the same concentration.

- Fire risk is elevated by open flames, hot oil and electrical equipment operating close together in a confined space.
- Knives and cutting equipment require focused attention, proper technique and secure storage when not in use.
- Hot surfaces, steam and splashing liquids present a constant burn and scald risk, worsened by any ship movement.
- Wet or greasy decks combined with ship motion significantly raise the risk of slips, trips and falls in the galley.
- Fatigue and time pressure during meal preparation increase the likelihood of a lapse in any of the above precautions.



Know Your Extinguisher

A galley fire involving hot fat must never be fought with water — know the location and correct class of extinguisher, or the fire blanket, before you need it.

Four Areas of Galley Safety

Each area calls for its own specific habits, built up through routine.



Fire Safety Equipment

Know the location and use of the fire blanket, the correct extinguisher class, and any galley fire suppression system.



Knife Handling

Keep knives sharp, use the correct board, cut away from the body, and store blades in a fixed rack, never loose in a drawer.



Hot Surfaces & Burns

Use dry cloths or gloves for hot handles and trays, and warn others verbally before moving hot liquids through the galley.



Non-Slip & Housekeeping

Wear non-slip footwear, wipe spills immediately, and keep floor mats and drains clear and in good condition.

Working the Galley in a Seaway

Heavy weather changes what is safe to do in the galley — plan meals and movements accordingly.



Do

- Secure pots, pans and containers using fiddles or rails before rough weather
- Reduce to simple, pre-prepared meals when the ship's motion makes cooking hazardous
- Keep a wide stance and one hand free for holding on while moving hot items
- Warn the bridge if galley conditions make normal meal service unsafe



Don't

- Don't carry hot liquids in open containers during heavy rolling or pitching
- Don't deep-fry or use unsecured open flames in significant sea states
- Don't leave equipment or utensils loose on worktops in rough weather
- Don't attempt complex, multi-pot cooking when conditions call for simpler meals



SECTION 6

Waste Management in the Galley

06

Galley waste is regulated cargo the moment it leaves the ship — MARPOL Annex V governs exactly how and where it can go.

MARPOL Annex V in the Galley

MARPOL Annex V restricts and, in most cases, prohibits the discharge of garbage, including food waste, into the sea.

- Food waste may only be discharged under specific conditions of distance from land and, in many areas, is prohibited entirely.
- Galley waste must be segregated at source into the categories set by the Company's Garbage Management Plan: food waste, plastics, and other categories.
- All discharges and disposals ashore of galley-generated waste must be logged in the Garbage Record Book, by category and quantity.
- Special Areas under MARPOL Annex V impose stricter discharge restrictions than open ocean — the cook should know which apply on the current voyage.
- Plastics of any kind — including packaging generated in the galley — must never be discharged to sea under any circumstances.



Log It At Source

Recording galley waste generation and disposal as it happens, not from memory later, keeps the Garbage Record Book accurate and audit-ready.

SEGREGATION

Galley Waste Categories

Correct segregation at the point of generation is the single biggest factor in MARPOL Annex V compliance.

Category	Examples	Handling
Food Waste	Peelings, scraps, spoiled food, plate waste	Comminuted or ground where required; distance/area rules apply
Plastics	Packaging, wrappers, containers, cling film	Never discharged to sea; stored for shore disposal
Metal & Glass	Tins, jars, bottles	Stored separately for shore disposal or recycling
Cooking Oil / Grease	Used frying oil, fat trap residue	Collected separately, never poured down drains or overboard

Good Waste Habits in the Galley

Consistent daily habits are what keep waste segregation accurate under the pressure of routine service.



Segregate at the Source

Sort waste into the correct labelled bin the moment it is generated, not at the end of the shift.



Minimise Waste Generation

Plan portions and prep quantities carefully to reduce food waste before it is even created.



Secure Storage Before Disposal

Keep segregated waste in covered, pest-proof storage until it can be legally discharged or landed ashore.



Accurate Logging

Record category, quantity and method of disposal in the Garbage Record Book promptly and honestly.



COURSE COMPLETE

A well-run galley keeps the whole ship fed, healthy and ready to work — every meal, every day, every voyage.

Company DPA — 24/7 emergency line

Fleet Catering / Technical Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr